

D341

Cloud Deployment and Operations

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An insurance company, which recently moved its headquarters, says its claims system may lose no more than 15 minutes of data in a disaster and must be back online within 4 hours. The system was built by a team of eight developers. What is the RPO?

- A. 15 minutes.
- B. 4 hours.
- C. 8 hours.
- D. 4 hours 15 minutes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A system is backed up every 6 hours and can be restored in 1 hour. Which requirement would it fail?

- A. An RTO of 2 hours.
- B. An RPO of 1 hour.
- C. An RTO of 6 hours.
- D. An RPO of 8 hours.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A nonprofit runs a full backup every Sunday night and incremental backups Monday through Thursday nights. The backups are stored in a second region chosen by a board member. The database fails Friday morning. How many backup sets are needed to restore?

- A. 5 — Sunday's full plus Monday-Thursday incrementals.
- B. 4 — the incrementals only.
- C. 2 — Sunday's full plus Thursday's incremental.
- D. 1 — Thursday's incremental.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

With a full backup Sunday and differential backups Monday through Thursday, how many sets are needed to restore on Friday?

- A.** 5 — the full plus all four differentials.
- B.** 1 — Thursday's differential.
- C.** 2 — the full plus Thursday's differential.
- D.** 4

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A payment processor needs its service to keep running with near-zero downtime and near-zero data loss if an entire region fails. Its CFO recently praised the team's cost discipline. Which DR strategy fits?

- A.** Backup and restore.
- B.** Any strategy, since all DR options recover instantly.
- C.** Pilot light.
- D.** Multi-site active/active across regions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A small internal wiki can be down for a day and lose a day of edits. Which DR strategy is most cost-effective?

- A.** Multi-site active/active.
- B.** Backup and restore.
- C.** Warm standby.
- D.** No DR plan at all.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A streaming service releases a new recommendation engine. It sends 5% of users to the new version, watches error rates for an hour, then increases the share. The team uses a popular chat app to coordinate. Which deployment strategy is this?

- A. Blue/green.
- B. Rolling.
- C. Canary.
- D. Big-bang.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team wants to be able to roll back instantly by pointing all traffic back to the previous environment, which stays fully running. Which strategy provides this?

- A. Rolling.
- B. Blue/green.
- C. Canary.
- D. In-place upgrade.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A retailer's staging and production environments were built from the same template, but an engineer fixed a production outage by changing settings in the console. The fix happened during a holiday weekend. What is the best follow-up?

- A. Ban all changes on holidays.
- B. Make the same console change in staging by hand.
- C. Leave it; production is working.
- D. Put the change into the version-controlled template and redeploy so environments match.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An online form service's autoscaling group scales on disk space used. During a marketing campaign, requests triple and response times climb, but no new instances launch. The campaign was designed by an outside agency. What is the most likely fix?

- A.** Scale up to one very large instance.
- B.** Raise the disk-space threshold.
- C.** Ask the agency to reduce traffic.
- D.** Scale on a load metric such as CPU or request count per instance.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11.

A travel site wants the on-call engineer paged when average API latency stays above 800 ms for five minutes. The engineers work from three countries. What should they configure?

- A.** An alarm on the latency metric with the threshold and period.
- B.** Search the logs by hand each morning.
- C.** A monthly report of latency.
- D.** Nothing; latency is always visible to users anyway.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A manufacturer needs to move 5 TB a day between its data center and the cloud with steady, predictable latency. It currently uses a regional internet provider that won a customer-service award. Which option fits best?

- A.** Keep the award-winning provider because service is good.
- B.** Place servers in a public subnet.
- C.** A dedicated private connection to the cloud provider.
- D.** A site-to-site VPN over the internet.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

An insurance company, ~~which recently moved its headquarters,~~ says its claims system may lose no more than 15 minutes of data in a disaster and must be back online within 4 hours. ~~The system was built by a team of eight developers.~~ What is the RPO?

Target word: RPO value **Decides:** RPO is the data-loss limit.

A	Correct	The allowed data loss window.
B	Inverted operation	That is the RTO.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses the developer count.
D	Adjacent category	Adds two different measures.

2. Answer B Concept 1 · transfer

A system is backed up every 6 hours and can be restored in 1 hour. Which requirement would it fail?

Target word: which target is missed **Decides:** Up to 6 hours of data can be lost.

A	Inverted operation	A 1-hour restore meets a 2-hour RTO.
B	Correct	Backups 6 hours apart can lose up to 6 hours of data.
C	Confusion set	Mixes backup interval with recovery time; 1 hour meets it.
D	Wrong stem number	6-hour backups meet an 8-hour RPO.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A nonprofit runs a full backup every Sunday night and incremental backups Monday through Thursday nights. The backups are stored in a second region ~~chosen by a board member.~~ The database fails Friday morning. How many backup sets are needed to restore?

Target word: restore set count **Decides:** Incremental restores need the full plus every incremental since.

A	Correct	Each incremental holds only one day's changes.
B	Inverted operation	Incrementals cannot be restored without the full base.
C	Confusion set	That is the differential rule.
D	Dropped element	Drops the full backup and earlier incrementals.

4. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

With a full backup Sunday and differential backups Monday through Thursday, how many sets are needed to restore on Friday?

Target word: restore set count for differential **Decides:** Each differential holds all changes since the full.

A	Confusion set	That is the incremental rule.
B	Dropped element	Still needs the full base.
C	Correct	The latest differential already includes all earlier changes.
D	Wrong stem number	Counts the differentials only.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A payment processor needs its service to keep running with near-zero downtime and near-zero data loss if an entire region fails. ~~Its CFO recently praised the team's cost discipline.~~ Which DR strategy fits?

Target word: DR strategy **Decides:** Near-zero RTO and RPO.

A	Camouflage	Cheapest, fits the cost remark, but takes hours to recover.
B	Absolute language	Recovery times differ widely.
C	Adjacent category	Keeps only core pieces running; scaling up takes time.
D	Correct	Only full capacity running in both regions meets near-zero targets.

6. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A small internal wiki can be down for a day and lose a day of edits. Which DR strategy is most cost-effective?

Target word: cheapest strategy that meets loose targets **Decides:** RTO and RPO of about a day.

A	Inverted operation	Most costly; far more than needed.
B	Correct	Lowest cost and meets day-long targets.
C	Adjacent category	Pays for running capacity not needed here.
D	Absolute language	Without backups there is nothing to restore.

7. Answer C Concept 4

A streaming service releases a new recommendation engine. It sends 5% of users to the new version, watches error rates for an hour, then increases the share. ~~The team uses a popular chat app to coordinate.~~ Which deployment strategy is this?

Target word: name the strategy **Decides:** A small share of traffic first, then increase.

A	Confusion set	Blue/green switches all traffic at once between environments.
B	Adjacent category	Rolling replaces instances in batches, not by user share.
C	Correct	A small group tests the release before wider rollout.
D	Inverted operation	Releases to everyone at once.

8. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A team wants to be able to roll back instantly by pointing all traffic back to the previous environment, which stays fully running. Which strategy provides this?

Target word: strategy with instant full rollback **Decides:** Two full environments, switch all traffic.

A	Inverted operation	Old instances are replaced, so rollback means redeploying.
B	Correct	The old environment stays live for instant switch-back.
C	Confusion set	Shifts traffic gradually, not via a full standby environment.
D	Adjacent category	Overwrites the old version.

9. Answer D Concept 5

A retailer's staging and production environments were built from the same template, but an engineer fixed a production outage by changing settings in the console. ~~The fix happened during a holiday weekend.~~ What is the best follow-up?

Target word: correct IaC practice **Decides:** A manual change created drift from the template.

A	Camouflage	Timing is not the problem.
B	Adjacent category	Spreads manual drift instead of fixing the template.
C	Dropped element	Drift will be overwritten or cause surprises later.
D	Correct	Keeps the template as the source of truth.

10. Answer D Concept 6

An online form service's autoscaling group scales on disk space used. During a marketing campaign, requests triple and response times climb, but no new instances launch. ~~The campaign was designed by an outside agency.~~ What is the most likely fix?

Target word: why scaling failed **Decides:** Disk space does not track request load.

A	Adjacent category	Avoids the real fix and adds a single point of failure.
B	Inverted operation	Makes the wrong metric even less likely to trigger.
C	Camouflage	Who designed the campaign does not matter.
D	Correct	The metric must rise with demand.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A travel site wants the on-call engineer paged when average API latency stays above 800 ms for five minutes. ~~The engineers work from three countries.~~ What should they configure?

Target word: tool for threshold alerting **Decides:** Numeric latency over time with a threshold.

A	Correct	Metric alarms fire on thresholds.
B	Adjacent category	Logs support investigation, not real-time paging.
C	Inverted operation	After the fact, not a live alert.
D	Absolute language	The goal is to act before users notice.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A manufacturer needs to move 5 TB a day between its data center and the cloud with steady, predictable latency. It currently uses a regional internet provider ~~that won a customer service award.~~ Which option fits best?

Target word: connectivity choice **Decides:** High volume with steady latency.

A	Camouflage	Support quality does not guarantee latency.
B	Adjacent category	Changes exposure, not link quality.
C	Correct	Gives consistent bandwidth and latency.
D	Confusion set	Quick and cheap, but latency varies.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	RPO vs. RTO	RPO is the most data loss allowed (how far back you restore to); RTO is the most downtime allowed (how fast you must be running again).	Swapping the two, or thinking backup frequency sets RTO.	“How much data” vs. “how long down”.
2	Full, incremental, and differential backups	Incremental backs up changes since the last backup of any kind (fast backup, many restore sets); differential backs up changes since the last full (bigger backups, restore needs full + latest differential).	Thinking an incremental restore needs only the latest incremental.	A backup schedule and a failure day.
3	Disaster recovery strategies	Backup and restore → pilot light → warm standby → multi-site active/active: each step costs more and recovers faster.	Choosing the cheapest option for a near-zero RTO.	A stated RTO or RPO with a budget.
4	Deployment strategies	Blue/green switches all traffic between two full environments for instant rollback; canary sends a small share of traffic to the new version first; rolling replaces instances in batches.	Mixing up canary and blue/green.	“Small percentage of users” vs. “switch everything at once”.
5	Infrastructure as code	Define resources in version-controlled templates so environments are repeatable, reviewable, and free of manual drift.	Fixing production by hand and leaving templates unchanged.	Environments that differ or changes made in the console.
6	Autoscaling on the right metric	Scale on a metric that tracks load (CPU, request count, queue depth) with a target and cool-down; instances should be stateless.	Scaling on a metric that does not reflect demand, or storing sessions on instances.	An autoscaling group that does not react, or users losing sessions.
7	Metrics, logs, and alarms	Metrics are numeric time series for alarms and trends; logs are event records for investigation; alarms fire on thresholds so teams act before users notice.	Relying on logs alone for real-time alerting.	Need to be notified vs. need to find out why.
8	Hybrid connectivity and subnet design	Site-to-site VPN runs encrypted over the internet (fast to set up, variable performance); a dedicated private link gives consistent bandwidth and latency. Private subnets reach the internet outbound through NAT.	Expecting a VPN to guarantee steady latency.	Steady high throughput needs vs. quick, cheap setup.

Course scope (public description): Cloud Deployment and Operations provides students with technical skills in the deployment, management, and operations of cloud services. This course allows students to examine stability and scalability, backup and recovery processes, and deployment best practices. Provisioning of cloud resources,

monitoring of cloud resources, and managing connectivity are also examined. The following courses are prerequisites: Cloud Applications and AWS Cloud Architecture.